

WELFARE SCHEMES EMPOWERING SOCIAL JUSTICE

Telangana has implemented several welfare schemes aimed at empowering social justice and uplift of marginalized sections of society, and improving the overall well-being of the people of the State.

Dalit Bandhu is a transformative welfare scheme launched by the Government of Telangana with an aim to empower Dalit families to achieve its avowed mission of ensuring social justice. The scheme is designed to address the socio-economic disparities faced by Dalit communities and uplift them through financial assistance and state support.

Dalit Bandhu ranks among the most popular of the welfare schemes. It provides employment and promotes self-development. Dalit Bandhu Scheme directly transfers Rs. 10 lakh with 100% grant to the beneficiary, which is the largest direct cash transfer scheme without any collateral security in the country.

The government has released Rs.**3832.30** crore to **38,323** beneficiaries while for FY 2023-24 the government has allocated Rs.**17,700** crore to benefit **1,77,000** SC families.

The government's concern for below poverty line people, among other often ignored sections, is evidenced by the fact that in FY 2022-23 an amount of Rs.**10,502** crores was disbursed, while for FY 2023-24 over Rs.**11,774** crore has been allocated. The **Asara Pension** scheme has benefitted **43.85** lakh persons belonging to 10 different categories, including Old-Age Persons, Widows, Disabled, Toddy-Tappers, Weavers, HIV, Filaria and Dialysis patients, beedi workers and single women.

In the FY 2022-23, Rs.**12,722** crores bank credits were disbursed to **2,25,053** SHGs. Since the formation of Telangana State, the overall amount so disbursed was a whopping Rs.**69,000** crore. That apart, Rs.**2,911** crore was sanctioned by the State Government to **3,87,490** **Self Help Groups** (SHGs) under Vaddileni Runalu (interest-free) scheme.

Under the **Kalyana Lakshmi scheme,** poor families are assisted with an amount of Rs.**1,00,116** for performing marriages of daughters. So far, **13.16** lakh girls have been extended financial support to the tune of Rs.**11.109** crore.

Under **ST special Development Fund** (Sub plan) Act, there was an outlay of Rs.**47,258.34** crore in eight and a half years, apart from which there is an outlay of Rs.**639.24** crore for **13,264** aspiring SC and ST entrepreneurs.

Each of the 12 ST (reserved) Assembly constituencies gets Rs. one crore for constructing self-esteem buildings for tribals while Rs.**21.50** crore was spent on Kumaram Bheem Adivasi Bhavan in Hyderabad and Rs.**21.71** crore on Sewalal Banjara Bhavan. Additionally the popular biennial Medaram jatara, Asia's largest tribal fair, has an outlay of Rs.**354** crore.

TS –Pride - Rs.**2,747** crores spent on **60,904** Dalits; free electricity of up to 101 units for SCs and to **18,30,478** Dalit houses at a cost of Rs.**251.36** crore.

